FREE HOBBY STARTER KIT

Bird-Watching

For the grown-up · read this first, then hand over the log

Bird-watching is the hobby with the lowest barrier to entry of the six in this kit: the gear you need is a window, a few minutes of patience, and this printed log. You do not need binoculars to start — a park bench, a porch, or even a kitchen window during breakfast works fine.

How to hand it over

- **Start at a window or garden spot.** Ask: "How many different birds can we spot before the kettle boils?" Small, silly challenges work.
- **Count kinds, not totals.** Ten of the same sparrow is one bird for a beginner's log — one of each *kind* keeps it interesting.
- **Describe before identifying.** Size (smaller than a sparrow? bigger than a pigeon?), color patches, beak shape, and what it was doing are enough. A field guide or free app can come later.
- **Sound counts.** A bird heard but never seen still goes in the log with a note like "heard only."

> **Good first questions:** What was it doing? Was it alone or in a group? Where was it — feeder, fence, tree top, water? Those three answers make nearly every entry feel like a real observation.

The no-gear rule

Everything a beginner needs is on the next page: a dated log, a small weather line, and a behavior checklist. If you later want binoculars or an app, that's a bonus — not the starting point.

Print pages 2–3 for the log book or as single sheets when the first one fills up.

Bird-Watching Log

One row per kind of bird. "Seen" and "Heard" both count. Guessing is allowed — write a question mark if you're not sure.

DATE	TIME	WHERE (WINDOW, PARK, TRAIL…)	BIRD DESCRIBED	WHAT IT WAS DOING	HOW MANY	NOTES

Today's weather

Sky:	
Wind:	
Temperature:	

Spotting shortcuts

- Bigger or smaller than a sparrow?
- Brightest color patch?
- Beak: long, short, thick, thin?
- Ground or tree top?
- Alone or with friends?

> **Best times:** early morning and just before sunset are the busiest bird hours. A rainy-after-rain drizzle also gets everything moving.

Six Weeks of Bird Days

Tick a box each day you go spotting — even one minute at a window counts. Fill the whole row in one week and you have a streak.

WEEK	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							

First list: birds I want to find

- ☐ A bird with a red patch
- ☐ A bird pecking a tree
- ☐ A bird walking on the ground in a group
- ☐ A bird near water
- ☐ A bird I can name without help
- ☐ A bird I can identify by its song alone
- ☐ A bird in the rain
- ☐ A bird I have never seen in our yard before

> **Graduation day:** once a week of entries is full, re-read them together and pick the best bird of the week. Starting next week's list with "birds I still want to see" keeps the hunt alive.